

Dedication

I dedicate this book to all those who, at some point in their lives, have felt that they needed to be someone else to be accepted.

To those who fight silent battles in front of the mirror, trying to hide parts of themselves to please the world.

I also dedicate it to those who carry the weight of a denied identity, to the voices that have been silenced and to the stories that never had the courage to be told.

May these pages serve as reflection, necessary discomfort and, who knows, an invitation to reconciliation with what we really are.

And, above all, I dedicate this book to those who are still at war with their own reality, in the hope that one day they will find peace within themselves.

**A Man who is black, who thinks he is White and
hates Black people.**

All human beings fight battles that the world never sees. Some are silent, hidden behind well-rehearsed smiles, proudly displayed achievements, and stories carefully constructed to look perfect. Others happen within the mind, where memories, insecurities, and desires are mixed, creating conflicts that do not always have a clear solution. This is a story about one of those battles.

This work delves into the complexity of human identity, exploring how social influences, cultural environments, and personal experiences can transform the way someone views themselves. It is not just about racism, prejudice or social acceptance. It is something even deeper: the psychological impact that arises when a person comes to believe that they need to deny parts of their own existence in order to be valued.

The protagonist of this story, **Lucifer**, represents a reality that is often ignored or misunderstood. He wasn't born hating who he is. On the contrary, his vision was built slowly, shaped by environments, social relations, and patterns that were presented to him as absolute truths.

Throughout his life, he learned that success, respect, and recognition were associated with a model of identity that did not reflect his origin. Instead of questioning this model, he decided to pursue it with all his might.

But the human being is not only made of conscious choices. There are feelings that remain kept, doubts that insist on arising and truths that, no matter how much they are ignored, continue to exist. The attempt to escape one's own identity can create external achievements, but it can also generate internal conflicts that silently accumulate, waiting for the moment when they can no longer be ignored.

Throughout this narrative, the reader will follow the trajectory of a man who has built a carefully planned image for the world, but who faces a constant war within himself. Between friendships that challenge his beliefs, social relationships that reinforce his insecurities, and episodes that put his reality to the test, Lucifer will be led to confront what he has spent his entire life trying to hide.

Alongside him, characters emerge who represent different ways of seeing identity, belonging and personal pride. **Laynel**, with his firm stance and awareness of his roots, works as a counterpoint that exposes difficult truths. Richard, on the other hand, symbolizes the world that Lucifer wishes to integrate, but which constantly imposes invisible limits that reveal how far social acceptance goes.

Between encounters, conflicts and moments of introspection, this story seeks to provoke reflections that go beyond the protagonist's individual experience. She invites the reader to question the extent to which the search for acceptance can influence decisions, behaviors, and even the way someone sees their own identity.

More than presenting answers, this work intends to raise uncomfortable questions, the kind that are rarely asked out loud.

"Between Mirrors and Lies" is not just a story about a specific man. It is a portrait of the social pressures that shape behaviors, the insecurities that often remain hidden, and the internal battles that can define the course of a lifetime. It is a narrative about choices, consequences and the difficult task of facing one's reflection when it reveals truths that we would prefer to ignore.

When starting this reading, the reader will not find only a personal trajectory. You will also find an opportunity to reflect on identity, belonging and the complexity of human nature. Because, at some point in life, we have all found ourselves in front of a mirror, trying to decide if we are looking at who we really are or at the image we have learned to build in order to survive.

Chapter 1

Reflexes and First Picks

Lucifer always knew he was different. Not in the physical or genetic sense, but in the way he saw the world and, above all, how he believed the world saw him. By the time he was 28, he had built a carefully planned routine: a modern downtown apartment, luxury cars, work contracts that impressed colleagues and friends, and a social circle made up almost exclusively of white, influential, and successful people. For him, this was the standard of success, the mirror he wanted to reflect.

From a young age, he grew up surrounded by images, behaviors, and values that did not fit his racial reality. He absorbed every detail: the way white people interacted, how they spoke, the places they frequented, even the way they dressed and the tone of their voice. Everything was studied, analyzed, adapted. Lucifer learned early on that in order to be valued in that environment, he needed to deny parts of himself and he did this with surgical precision.

But denying one's identity is not simple. He knew it, even if he pretended not to feel it. Every look in the mirror was a silent reminder that he had built a wall between him and who he really was.

Behind the façade of self-confidence and arrogance, there was insecurity, fear of being rejected, and the constant need to prove that he deserved his place in that world.

Laynel, his longtime friend, was one of the few people who could see this duality. They met as teenagers, in situations that required loyalty, patience and genuine friendship. Unlike Lucifer, Laynel was proud of his own roots and never felt the need to deny his identity in order to be accepted. His presence, as friendly as he was, was a constant reminder that Lucifer was living a carefully constructed lie.

The first meeting with Richard, a man Lucifer admired and feared, consolidated the realization that his social life needed constant maintenance. Richard was not overtly cruel, but his subtle attitudes and comments always put Lucifer to the test, reminding him that no matter how hard he tried, there were still invisible barriers that he could not control. Each interaction reinforced the idea that he needed to remain attentive, aligned and, above all, invisible in his origins.

That morning, Lucifer got up early, got ready precisely, put on his expensive suit, and walked to the mirror. He observed the reflection of someone the world respected, someone who seemed to have everything under control. But deep down, I knew that that reflection was a construction. A necessary disguise.

A character he played better than any other. And as he adjusted his tie, he made a silent choice: he would continue to play the role that society expected, no matter the cost.

The city was still awakening, but Lucifer was already moving with calculated confidence. Every step, every gesture, was measured to impress, to consolidate his position. And so began another day in which he would need to balance success, power and the truth that insisted on chasing him the truth that, no matter how much he was admired, a part of himself remained ignored, denied and distant.

The day continued with Lucifer leaving home for breakfast in a restaurant frequented by people from the same social circle he longed to belong to. As he looked at the faces around him, he felt the silent weight of the dissonance between who he was and who he pretended to be. A sense of tension that he would learn to carry with him his entire life, a tension that would begin to become unbearable over time, setting the stage for the encounters and conflicts that were yet to come.

Chapter 2

Invisible Confrontations

Monday, March 3, 2025 - 08:45

The alarm clock rang punctually at 7 a.m., but Lucifer had been awake for almost an hour. He stood up, put on his dark gray suit and walked to the balcony of his 22nd-floor apartment, watching the city move slowly. The sight of the metropolis gave him a sense of control: everything seemed predictable, orderly, tailored to him. But behind that façade, he felt the restlessness of someone who lives in conflict with himself.

Upon arriving at the breakfast of the executive club, Lucifer saw Richard, sitting at his usual table, surrounded by high-ranking white colleagues. Richard looked up, greeted him with a cold smile and an almost imperceptible gesture. For Lucifer, Richard's every little move was loaded with meaning, a silent reminder that no matter how hard he tried to fit in, there were still unseen limits to his acceptance.

"*Good morning, Lucifer,*" Richard said, his voice calm, almost contemptuous.

"*Good morning, Richard,*" Lucifer replied, measuring every word.

The tension between them was palpable. Laynel, who was in the same room at another table, watched the scene with concern. He knew that the need for Lucifer's approval in that social circle left him vulnerable to small attacks, which Richard seemed to master masterfully.

Tuesday, March 4, 2025 - 15:30

In the office, Lucifer received a message from Laynel:

"Hey man, we need to talk about that weekend event. I don't think you realized what happened."

He quickly typed the answer, trying to sound nonchalant:

"All right, Laynel. I know what I'm doing."

Even so, Laynel's words remained in Lucifer's mind. He knew that the denial of his origins was creating internal fissures, but the idea of admitting it out loud was unthinkable. Pride and the desire to be accepted in a world that he thought superior were stronger than any reflection of conscience.

Wednesday, March 5, 2025 - 19:20

A party at Richard's penthouse brought together the social cream that Lucifer so much wanted to be part of. There were influential colleagues, renowned businessmen and figures who symbolized absolute status. Lucifer walked around the space confidently, greeting everyone, smiling, but each smile carried the weight of a carefully constructed mask.

Meanwhile, Laynel watched from afar, noting the small cracks in Lucifer's behavior. He approached discreetly and said, *"You don't realize you're losing yourself, do you? Every step you take to impress this world; you move further away from who you really are."*

Lucifer just smiled, with a hint of disdain: *"I know what I do, Laynel. You don't have to worry about me."*

At that moment, Richard appeared next to them. His presence was imposing, and the atmosphere carried immediate tension.

"Lucifer, it's always interesting to see someone so... dedicated. But be careful not to lose yourself in the process," Richard said, with a calculatedly neutral smile.

The comment, though subtle, struck Lucifer deeply. He looked away, feeling the weight of a truth, he never wanted to face: even within the world he longed for, he continued to be judged by standards he couldn't control.

The evening ended with Lucifer returning home, thoughtful. Between messages from Laynel and silent interactions with Richard, he realized that the internal war he waged wasn't just about social belonging. It was about identity, acceptance, and the consequences of denying who you really are.

Reflection of the night:

Lucifer knew that he was surrounded by people who symbolized power and success, but he also knew that every step toward this world was a choice to move away from himself. And, no matter how hard he tried, the awareness that something was wrong did not let him sleep peacefully.

Even in the most glamorous environments, the invisible pressure on Lucifer grows, creating internal conflicts that would only increase as the story progressed.

Chapter 3

Echoes of the Past

Thursday, March 6, 2025 - 09:10

Lucifer awoke to the echo of an argument that had taken place at Richard's party two days earlier. Every word Laynel said seemed to reverberate in his mind: *"Every step you take to impress this world, you move further away from who you really are."* He stood up, dressed carefully, choosing a navy-blue suit that gave him authority and elegance, and headed to the office of his own financial venture.

On the way, he received a call from Richard:

- Lucifer, I hope you are ready for today's meeting. I want to present a possible investment. Something that can put us ahead of everyone else in the market.

"Of course, Richard. I will be there punctually. Lucifer replied, feeling the chill down his spine that always appeared at any interaction with him.

The meeting took place in a glass building in the center of the city, where the reflected light reinforced the sense of superficial transparency that Lucifer admired so much. Richard presented the investment in detail, but in each sentence, there was a subtlety that reminded Lucifer that he was still, to that world, a guest in foreign territory.

Laynel appeared unexpectedly in the building, bringing with him a memory of the past.

- Lucifer, we need to talk before you make any rash decisions, Laynel said firmly.

Lucifer looked away for a moment, trying to hide the uneasiness that Laynel was provoking.

- Not now, Laynel. I'm busy.

- Always busy, but I can never get away from what really matters. Lucifer, you are forgetting yourself. Laynel's voice carried frustration and concern.

Saturday, March 8, 2025 - 18:50

After a long day, Lucifer decided to meet some friends at a sophisticated bar in the city. Among them was Matthew, who had recently approached Lucifer's social circle, but who, unlike Laynel, admired his attitude of denial of his origins.

Matthew tried to ease the tension:

- Dude, are you always so serious? Let's enjoy the night.

- Just enjoy it too, Matthew. It's not all fun, Lucifer replied, without taking his eyes off the entrance to the bar.

At that moment, Richard entered with a group of acquaintances, and the tension manifested itself again. Lucifer realized how his need for acceptance in that world was mixed with fear and inner anger. He felt, for the first time, that he could not simply choose to be part of that environment without consequences for his mind and for his identity.

Sunday, March 9, 2025 - 11:30

Lucifer received a message from Laynel:

"Don't expect the world to accept you while you run away from who you are. This internal war will take its toll sooner or later."

He did not immediately respond. Instead, he sat in his favorite armchair, staring at the reflection in the window glass. For a moment, he imagined himself different: accepting his own color, his history, without the weight of external approval. But the idea was too scary. The life he built was based on a carefully planned lie, and dismantling it seemed impossible.

At the end of the day, Lucifer had a brief conversation with Richard, who noticed his uneasiness.

- Lucifer, there are times when we all reflect on who we are and where we are going. Don't shy away from those moments, Richard said, his voice calm and controlled.

Lucifer left the office, his mind buzzing. He knew that every interaction, every look, every word of Richard and Laynel was loaded with a meaning greater than just business or friendship.

It was a psychological game, a silent war about identity, acceptance and belonging. And he was not yet ready to admit that by trying to be white in a white world, he was missing something essential of himself.